

Day 12 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Geography of India: Soil, Minerals & Natural Resources

READING MATERIAL

Fourth sub-topic of Geography Unit II. As with Rivers, real exam evidence shows a strong Tamil-Nadu-specific lean even within this all-India clause — TN's own soil types, mineral belts, and named deposits come up disproportionately.

Q: Real exam: Evaluate — (i) TN excels other states in lignite coal reserves and production (ii) TN has 90% of the country's lignite reserves (iii) the Neyveli lignite field is located in Villupuram district. Which is incorrect?

A: Only (iii) is incorrect — the Neyveli lignite field is actually in Cuddalore district (historically part of South Arcot), not Villupuram. (i) and (ii) are correct: Tamil Nadu does lead in lignite, holding roughly 90% of India's reserves.

Q: Real exam: Which Tamil Nadu district has 482 million tonnes of low-grade Iron ore reserves?

A: Salem (not Trichy, Madurai, or Coimbatore).

Q: What are the five main soil types found in Tamil Nadu?

A: Alluvial, Black, Red, Laterite, and Saline soils.

Q: What are the characteristics of Alluvial soil, and which TN districts have it?

A: Fertile, rich in lime/potassium/magnesium/phosphoric acid, porous and loamy, but deficient in nitrogen and humus. Found in Thanjavur, Tiruvarur, Nagapattinam, Villupuram, Cuddalore, Tirunelveli, and Kanyakumari.

Q: What minerals are the coastal districts of Tamil Nadu known for, and what are they used for?

A: Beach sand minerals — ilmenite, rutile, garnet, and zircon. Tamil Nadu also has bauxite, magnesite, and vermiculite deposits, used in aluminium production, fertilizers, and insulation materials respectively.

Q: Where is limestone abundant in Tamil Nadu, and what is it mainly used for?

A: Tirunelveli and Salem districts — a key raw material for cement production, also used in chemical and construction industries.

Q: What is Tamil Nadu particularly renowned for in terms of stone/rock resources?

A: Granite reserves, known for their quality and variety.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Neyveli lignite field is actually located in which district (not Villupuram, despite what some sources claim)?

A. Cuddalore ✓

B. Salem

C. Tirunelveli

D. Thanjavur

Explanation: Cuddalore district. [hard, question-bank-2026]

2. Which Tamil Nadu district has 482 million tonnes of low-grade Iron ore reserves?

A. Trichy

B. Madurai

C. Salem ✓

D. Coimbatore

Explanation: Salem. [medium, question-bank-2026]

3. Which soil type is fertile, rich in lime/potassium/phosphoric acid, but deficient in nitrogen and humus?

A. Black soil

B. Red soil

C. Alluvial soil ✓

D. Laterite soil

Explanation: Alluvial soil. [medium, web-research]

4. Beach sand minerals like ilmenite, rutile, garnet, and zircon are characteristic of which part of Tamil Nadu?

A. Western hill districts

B. Coastal districts ✓

C. Central plateau

D. Northern border districts

Explanation: Coastal districts. [medium, web-research]

5. Limestone, a key raw material for cement, is abundant in which two Tamil Nadu districts?

A. Salem and Tirunelveli ✓

B. Chennai and Coimbatore

C. Madurai and Trichy

D. Vellore and Erode

Explanation: Salem and Tirunelveli. [medium, web-research]

6. Tamil Nadu is particularly well known for which high-quality rock resource?

A. Marble

B. Granite ✓

C. Sandstone

D. Slate

Explanation: Granite. [easy, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Puzzles

READING MATERIAL

Puzzles is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. The genre overlaps with Logical Reasoning, so this topic focuses on archetypes NOT already covered there: comparison chains, age puzzles, family-relation puzzles, and linear seating arrangements — all extremely common TNPSC puzzle shapes.

Q: Method — comparison chain (not all four compared directly, must chain through clues): D is taller than C but not as tall as B. C is taller than A. Who is the tallest?

A: Chain it: $B > D > C > A$. So B is the tallest. The key technique: write each clue as an inequality, then merge them into one ordered chain rather than trying to compare all pairs mentally.

Q: Method — classic age puzzle: A father is 4 times as old as his son. In 20 years, he will be twice as old as his son. Find their current ages.

A: Let son's current age = x , father = $4x$. In 20 years: father = $4x+20$, son = $x+20$. Condition: $4x+20 = 2(x+20) \rightarrow 4x+20 = 2x+40 \rightarrow 2x=20 \rightarrow x=10$. Son is 10, father is 40.

Q: Method — family-relation puzzle: Pointing to a photograph, a man says, 'She is the daughter of my mother's only son.' How is the woman in the photo related to the man?

A: His daughter. 'My mother's only son' = the man himself (since he's referring to his own mother, and he's an only son). So 'her father' = the man, making the woman his daughter.

Q: Method — linear seating arrangement: Five friends P, Q, R, S, T sit in a row. Q is immediately to the right of P. R is at one end. S is between Q and T. T is not adjacent to P. Find the order.

A: Work from the most fixed clue first: R is at an end — try R at the left end. P-Q must be adjacent with Q right of P, and S is between Q and T, with T not adjacent to P. Testing R,P,Q,S,T: P-Q adjacent ✓, S between Q&T ✓, T not adjacent to P (T is at position 5, P at position 2, not adjacent) ✓, R at an end ✓. Order: R, P, Q, S, T.

Q: Method — distribution/sharing puzzle: A sum of money is divided among A, B, and C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets thrice as much as C. If C gets ₹600, find the total sum.

A: $C=600$. $B=3 \times 600=1800$. $A=2 \times 1800=3600$. Total = $3600+1800+600 = 6000$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. P is shorter than Q but taller than R. Q is shorter than S. Who is the tallest?

- A. P
- B. Q
- C. R
- D. S ✓**

Explanation: Chain: $S > Q > P > R$. S is tallest. [medium, authored]

2. A mother is 3 times as old as her daughter. In 15 years, she will be twice as old as her daughter. Find the daughter's current age.

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 15 ✓**
- D. 18

Explanation: Daughter= x , mother= $3x$. $3x+15=2(x+15) \rightarrow 3x+15=2x+30 \rightarrow x=15$. [medium, authored]

3. Pointing to a man, a woman says, 'He is the son of my father's only daughter.' If the woman has no siblings, how is the man related to her?

- A. Her son ✓**
- B. Her brother
- C. Her nephew
- D. Her father

Explanation: 'My father's only daughter' = the woman herself (she has no siblings). So the man is her son. [medium, authored]

4. ₹7,000 is divided among A, B, C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets twice as much as C. Find C's share.

- A. ₹1,000 ✓**
- B. ₹1,200

C. ₹1,500

D. ₹2,000

Explanation: Let $C=x$, $B=2x$, $A=4x$. Total= $7x=7000 \rightarrow x=1,000$. [medium, authored]

5. Four friends sit in a row. B is immediately right of A. C is at the left end. D is not adjacent to A. Find the correct order.

A. C, A, B, D ✓

B. A, B, C, D

C. C, D, A, B

D. D, A, B, C

Explanation: C at left end; A-B adjacent with B right of A; D not adjacent to A. Order C,A,B,D satisfies all three conditions. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Leisure" — William Henry Davies

READING MATERIAL

A short sonnet protesting how modern busyness leaves no time to appreciate nature and life. Real coaching-site evidence tests theme, the poem's central complaint, and a couple of specific figures of speech.

Q: Who wrote "Leisure", and where/when was it first published?

A: William Henry Davies, in his 1911 collection Songs of Joy and Others.

Q: What is the central theme and complaint of the poem?

A: Nature and awareness — the poet protests modern life's busyness, arguing that people have lost the time (and the habit) to simply 'stand and stare' at the natural world around them.

Q: What does the repeated line "No time to stand and stare" emphasize?

A: A lack of awareness — people are too busy to notice or appreciate the world around them.

Q: What is the poem's structure and rhyme scheme?

A: A 14-line sonnet, with rhyme scheme AABCCDDEEFFGG (rhyming couplets throughout, rather than a traditional Shakespearean or Petrarchan sonnet rhyme pattern).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Streams full of stars, like skies at night."

A: Simile — directly compares the streams (reflecting stars) to night skies, using 'like'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "What is this life if, full of care, / We have no time to stand and stare?"

A: Rhetorical question — posed for emphasis, not expecting a literal answer; it's the poem's opening and central provocation.

Q: What was distinctive about William Henry Davies' own life, relevant to this poem's theme?

A: He lived as a self-described 'super-tramp', deliberately rejecting conventional steady employment in favour of a wandering, leisure-prioritizing lifestyle — directly embodying the poem's own argument.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Leisure" was written by:

A. William Blake

B. W. H. Davies ✓

C. Robert Frost

D. John Keats

Explanation: William Henry Davies. [easy, web-research]

2. The central theme of "Leisure" is:

A. Technology and speed

B. Nature and awareness ✓

C. Anger and injustice

D. Loneliness

Explanation: Nature and awareness. [easy, web-research]

3. What does the poet criticize about modern lifestyle in this poem?

A. Over-eating

B. Excessive noise

C. Busyness and lack of leisure ✓

D. Travel and tourism

Explanation: Busyness and lack of leisure. [medium, web-research]

4. "Streams full of stars" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile ✓

B. Metaphor

C. Personification

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Simile (compared to night skies using 'like'). [medium, web-research]

5. "What is this life if, full of care, we have no time to stand and stare?" is an example of:

A. Alliteration

B. Irony

C. Hyperbole

D. Rhetorical question ✓

Explanation: Rhetorical question. [medium, web-research]

6. "Leisure" is structured as:

A. A 14-line sonnet with rhyming couplets ✓

B. A 4-stanza ballad

C. Free verse with no rhyme

D. A limerick

Explanation: A 14-line sonnet, rhyme scheme AABBCDDEEFFGG. [hard, web-research]